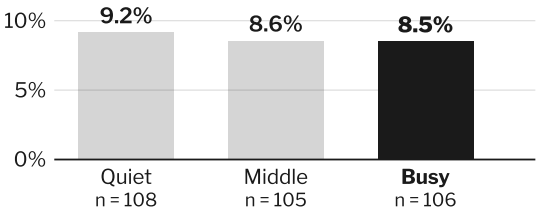
Busy ECM weeks don't show up in UK placing discounts. Relative size and AIM go with discounts 2 to 4pp deeper.

319 UK placings and accelerated bookbuilds of £10m or more, 2019 to 2026. Against deals in the same month, segment and industry, an extra £0.43bn of prior-week UK supply (a typical swing) moved the discount by about 1bp; a cost above 1.3pp per swing is ruled out at 95% confidence.

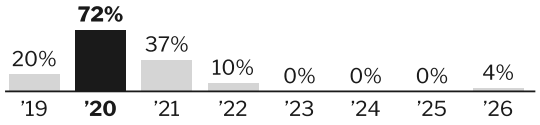
Data check. Every discount recomputed from the announcement and the last close before launch; matches company-stated figures on 124 deals (correlation 0.99).

Raw, busy weeks priced tighter

Mean discount, deals split into thirds by supply in the five trading days before launch. A 0.7pp gap, not significant (t = −0.45).



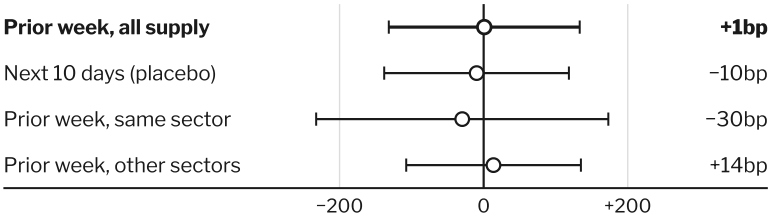
Share of each year's deals in the busiest third



"Busy" mostly means 2020: 62% of busy-third deals launched that year. From 2023, almost none qualify. The raw split compares years, not weeks.

Compared within the month, it's about zero

Each deal compared only with deals launched in the same calendar month, controlling for size, % of capital, market moves and deal terms. Specification fixed in advance.



● Significant at 5% ○ Not significant Lines: 95% intervals

Placebo: supply in the ten days *after* launch can't compete for the book, and it is flat too, so no market-window effect is masking a cost. Same-sector supply, where books should overlap most, is also flat. All 14 specifications agree, including without 2020. The interval is ±£0.4m on a £30m deal; a smaller cost cannot be ruled out.

Where raises priced, 2019 to 2026

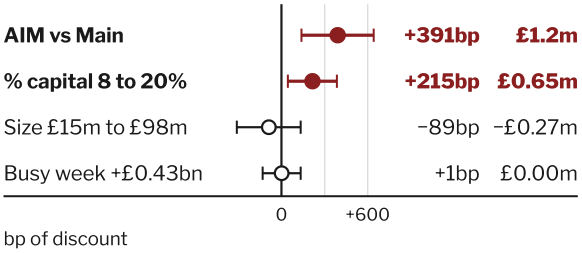
Discount to last close, %: median and interquartile range. Raw, no controls. A reference point, not a forecast.

	AIM			Main Market		
New shares, % of capital	Median	IQR	n	Median	IQR	n
10% or less	**6.3**	3.4–9.8	40	**4.2**	0.2–5.9	53
10 to 20%	**7.0**	3.9–14.5	33	**5.1**	3.4–8.5	29
20 to 40%	**10.2**	4.9–16.8	28	*12.9**		2
Over 40%	**14.7**	9.1–27.7	14	*21.3**		4
Not published	**9.0**	2.6–14.0	84	**5.8**	3.4–7.9	32
All deals	**8.4**	**3.8–14.3**	**199**	**5.0**	**2.4–7.7**	**120**

*** Fewer than five deals, indicative only**

What moves the discount

Same model. Positive means deeper, in bp and in £ on the median £30m deal. Associations, not causal estimates.



● Significant at 5% ○ Not significant Lines: 95% intervals

AIM averaged 10.6% against 5.6% on the Main Market; 391bp of that gap survives the controls.

Method. Discount: issue price vs last close before launch (same-day close for after-hours launches). Supply: £ of other UK equity raises of £10m or more (placings, rights issues, open offers, IPOs) in the five trading days before launch, relative to its 250-day average. OLS with year-month, segment and industry fixed effects; errors clustered by week. Single-investor and controller-led deals excluded. Sources: FCA NSM, LSE issuance data, market data.

Limits. Placings are pre-sounded, so a congestion cost may show in whether or how much is raised, not in price; untested. All supply counted equally, though a £2bn rights issue and a £15m AIM raise draw on different books. Sell-downs missing (no free source), likely biasing toward zero. Main Market thin after 2021. Open offers priced 6.5pp deeper (p = 0.004), probably reflecting the type of issuer that uses them. Open question: T+20 market-adjusted returns 1.9pp weaker per typical busy week (p = 0.14).

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Independent student research. Not investment advice. Deals to October 2026.